

In the sections that follow, we'll tell you how to use these techniques and the basic differences between the three.

Wireframing

The first step in UX designing is creating a 'wireframe'. A Wireframe is simply a sketch of your UI before any kind of design elements or development even takes place. In this stage, you'll be creating a basic visual representation of the elements – buttons, menus, footer, sidebar, etc – in your interface to define the basic layout of your interface. You're creating this wireframe to arrange elements in such a way as to best accomplish a particular purpose. A purpose that's usually informed by a business objective and a creative idea. For example, if your objective is to showcase the special products of the day, you'll place these products on the homepage of the website or in a banner near the app's menu bar, which is the the best way to highlight them.

The way you place the elements in an interface, which also includes navigational systems, gives you an idea of the page layout and the way the various parts of the website/app work together. This step focuses on what a screen does, not what it looks like. Wireframes can be pencil drawings or sketches on a whiteboard, or they can be produced by free or commercial software applications. When you create a wireframe of any website or app, you're basically creating the UI's layout followed by outlines of shapes like boxes of the most important pieces and colours (but only in grayscale, to keep it really simple).

Why do we need wireframes?

The wireframe lays out the basic blueprint or skeleton of an UI. It may



A simple wireframe to highlight the basic layout of a UI